

RISING BEYOND BORDERS

Document 14 — SEO, Metadata & Discoverability
Master Specification + Claude Code Implementation Prompt

Status: Implementation specification

Purpose: Establish one consistent, data-driven SEO and discoverability layer across the RBB website without introducing unsupported organizational, geographic, legal, impact or program claims.

1. Phase Objective

Documents 01–13 established the site's information architecture, content systems, public pages, forms and policy architecture. This phase makes metadata and crawl behavior consistent across those routes. SEO copy must remain derived from approved page content rather than becoming a second source of unverified claims.

2. Metadata Architecture

Create a shared metadata system, preferably alongside the existing content architecture. Suggested source: **src/content/seo.js**, or an equivalent shared SEO utility if the existing application already has an appropriate location.

- Every indexable page should have a unique title and meta description.
- Metadata should be generated from the same content source as the page wherever practical.
- Do not duplicate long page copy into metadata.
- Do not generate metadata from placeholder text such as “to be provided”.
- Do not put unverified statistics, countries, legal status, donation claims, team information or project claims into titles/descriptions.
- Route-level overrides should be possible for stories and future project/team profiles.

3. Recommended Metadata Model

Suggested fields:

route, title, description, canonicalPath, robots, ogTitle, ogDescription, ogImage, twitterCard, twitterTitle, twitterDescription, twitterImage, schemaType, schemaData, status.

Use **status: approved** or an equivalent guard where metadata depends on content that has not yet been approved.

4. Title Strategy

- Use the page's actual subject followed by the organization name where appropriate, e.g. “Our Work | Rising Beyond Borders”.
- Keep titles concise and useful; do not mechanically append keywords.
- Use one consistent organization name: “Rising Beyond Borders”.
- Story/project/team detail titles should use the approved item title plus the organization name.
- Do not create keyword-stuffed titles.
- Do not use unsupported descriptors such as “Canada's leading NGO” or similar promotional claims.

5. Meta Description Strategy

- Descriptions should accurately summarize visible approved content.

- Use natural language rather than keyword lists.
- Do not invent statistics, countries, beneficiaries, partnerships or donation outcomes.
- Pending pages should use neutral descriptions that do not imply unavailable content is published.
- Policy pages should not expose legal claims that are not in the approved policy.
- Empty directories should describe their purpose rather than fabricate examples.

6. Canonical URLs

Every public canonical page should have one canonical URL based on the established route architecture. Redirect aliases such as /donate, /about-us, /blogs and /reports must not become competing canonical URLs.

- Canonical URLs should use the production origin configured for deployment.
- Do not hard-code a guessed domain if the production domain has not been verified.
- Query-string filters should not automatically create separate canonical pages unless intentionally supported.
- Story/project/team detail pages should canonicalize to their stable slug route.
- Redirect routes should redirect rather than render duplicate page content.

7. Open Graph & Social Metadata

- Provide reusable Open Graph title, description and image handling.
- Provide Twitter/X-compatible card metadata where appropriate.
- Use approved RBB imagery only.
- If no approved image exists, omit the image rather than using a misleading placeholder.
- Images should have stable absolute URLs in production metadata.
- Do not expose private or draft team/story/project images through social metadata.

8. Robots & Indexing Rules

Page/state	Recommended behavior
Approved public content	index, follow
Pending policy page	noindex, follow or another deliberately chosen pending strategy
Empty directories with no content	noindex may be appropriate until useful content exists
Draft/pending story/project/team detail	noindex and not linked as public content
404 page	noindex
Redirect aliases	redirect; do not index as duplicate content
Dev/component catalogue	noindex; preferably blocked from public production navigation

9. Sitemap Architecture

- Generate a sitemap from actual canonical public routes rather than maintaining a second manually duplicated route list.
- Include approved public pages.

- Include approved story/project/team detail pages when they exist.
- Exclude redirects, 404 pages, pending/draft content and development-only routes.
- Do not include placeholder routes that do not represent useful public content.
- Use the production origin only after it is configured/verified.
- If the application is static, generate the sitemap during the production build or provide an equivalent deterministic mechanism.

10. robots.txt

Create a production-safe robots.txt strategy that points crawlers to the canonical sitemap and avoids accidentally blocking the entire site. Do not use robots.txt as the only mechanism for hiding private or draft content; unpublished content should not be publicly routable in the first place.

11. Structured Data / Schema

- Use structured data only where the page content genuinely supports it.
- Organization schema may be appropriate once RBB supplies the approved organization name, logo and public contact/social information.
- Article/NewsArticle schema may be appropriate for approved story content.
- BreadcrumbList may be used where the visible breadcrumb hierarchy exists.
- Person schema should only be considered for approved team profiles with approved public information.
- Do not invent addresses, telephone numbers, social profiles, awards, ratings, founding dates or other structured-data fields.
- Do not add FAQ schema merely because an FAQ component exists; the content must genuinely support it.

12. Dynamic Content Rules

Stories

Generate metadata from approved story title/excerpt/category/date. Draft or pending stories must not be indexed.

Projects

Generate metadata from approved project title/description/program. No project page should be generated from empty or unverified records.

Team

Generate metadata only for approved people. Do not expose draft/pending profile information through metadata or social tags.

Programs

Use the approved four program descriptions and avoid adding unsupported geographic or impact claims.

Policies

Pending policy pages must not look like published legal documents.

13. 404 & Error Metadata

- 404 pages should have a clear title and noindex behavior.
- Unknown dynamic slugs should resolve to the existing NotFound experience rather than creating thin pages.

- Do not put an unknown slug into an indexable title as if it were a real page.
- Server/build errors should not create indexable content.

14. Images & Metadata

- Use descriptive approved image alt text in page content.
- Social/OG images should have predictable dimensions and stable production URLs.
- Do not use missing-image placeholders as if they were real project/team imagery.
- Do not add unsupported location names into image filenames, alt text or captions.
- Future image optimization must preserve approved visual quality and layout.

15. Analytics & Search Console

No analytics or search-console provider has been approved in the current project. Do not add tracking or verification scripts during this phase. Create configuration hooks only if useful, and keep them disabled until RBB supplies the verified property/domain and approves the relevant technology/privacy configuration.

16. Claude Code Implementation Prompt

You are implementing Document 14 – SEO, Metadata & Discoverability for the Rising Beyond Borders website.

CONTEXT

- Documents 01-13 are implemented and approved.
- Existing routes and redirects are authoritative.
- RBB has not supplied a verified production domain, analytics provider, Search Console verification, or approved organization contact/social metadata.
- Do not invent SEO claims just to improve search visibility.

GOAL

Create a shared, data-driven SEO layer covering titles, descriptions, canonicals, social metadata, indexing, sitemap and robots behavior.

ARCHITECTURE

Create/reuse an SEO source/utility, preferably `src/content/seo.js` or the existing shared metadata utility.

Suggested fields:

```
{
  route,
  title,
  description,
  canonicalPath,
  robots,
  ogTitle,
  ogDescription,
  ogImage,
  twitterCard,
  twitterTitle,
  twitterDescription,
  twitterImage,
  schemaType,
  schemaData,
  status
}
```

RULES

- Metadata must describe visible approved content.
- Never invent statistics, countries, beneficiaries, partnerships, legal status, tax status, awards or organizational claims.
- Do not keyword-stuff titles/descriptions.
- Pending/draft content must not be indexed.
- Unknown dynamic slugs must use `NotFound`.
- Redirect aliases must redirect, not render duplicate pages.
- Do not guess the production domain.

CANONICALS

Use one canonical URL per public page. Established aliases such as `/donate`, `/about-us`, `/contact-us`, `/blogs` and `/reports` must not become competing canonical pages.

SOCIAL

Support OG/Twitter metadata through reusable utilities.

Use approved images only.

If no approved image exists, omit the image.

ROBOTS

- Approved public pages: `index`, `follow`.
- Pending/draft content: `noindex`.
- 404: `noindex`.
- Redirects: `redirect`.
- Dev/component catalogue: `noindex` and preferably not part of production navigation.

SITEMAP

Generate sitemap from actual canonical public routes/data.

Exclude redirects, pending/draft content, 404 and dev routes.

Use production origin only when verified/configured.

ROBOTS.TXT

Provide a safe robots.txt strategy with sitemap reference when the production origin is configured.

Do not block the whole site.

Do not rely on robots.txt to hide sensitive content.

STRUCTURED DATA

Use only where supported:

- Organization
- Article/NewsArticle
- BreadcrumbList
- Person for approved team profiles

Do not invent addresses, phones, social profiles, ratings, dates or other properties.

DYNAMIC CONTENT

Stories, projects and team profiles should generate metadata from approved records.
Programs use existing approved program descriptions.
Pending policy pages must not look like published legal documents.

ANALYTICS / SEARCH CONSOLE

Do not add analytics, tracking or Search Console scripts.
Create configuration hooks only if useful, but leave them disabled without approved RBB configuration.

VALIDATION

1. Production build passes with no warnings.
2. Inspect title/meta/canonical/robots tags on representative pages.
3. Verify redirects do not render duplicate content.
4. Verify unknown dynamic routes use NotFound.
5. Verify pending/draft content is not indexable.
6. Verify sitemap contains only canonical public routes.
7. Verify robots.txt is not overly restrictive.
8. Verify OG/Twitter metadata does not use unapproved imagery.
9. Verify no unsupported organizational/impact/geographic/legal claims appear in metadata.
10. No console errors/warnings.
11. No horizontal overflow.
12. Existing routes remain intact.

Do not commit or stage changes unless explicitly requested.

REPORT

Return:

- files created/modified
- metadata architecture
- canonical/redirect behavior
- robots/sitemap behavior
- structured-data behavior
- dynamic content handling
- validation results
- any production-domain or RBB approval decisions required.

17. Approval Checklist

- ✓ Shared metadata source/utility is implemented.
- ✓ Every intended public page has accurate metadata.
- ✓ No unsupported claims enter titles/descriptions/schema.
- ✓ Canonical URLs follow the established IA.
- ✓ Redirect aliases do not create duplicate pages.
- ✓ Pending/draft content is not indexable.
- ✓ Sitemap is generated from canonical public content.
- ✓ robots.txt is safe and includes the sitemap when the production origin is known.
- ✓ 404 pages are noindex.
- ✓ Structured data only uses verified fields.
- ✓ Analytics/Search Console remain disabled until approved.
- ✓ Responsive/build/console checks pass.

Important: SEO should improve discoverability of the approved RBB website, not become a mechanism for introducing claims that do not exist in the source content. The production domain and any analytics/search-verification configuration should be handled only after RBB confirms them.